

A still from Episode 1, *Raasta Sapnon Ka*

This time around, the collaborators meet on the same level. In fact, in some circles, the folk artists, most of whom write their own songs, may be better known. Manki and Tipaniya, for instance, are both Padma Shri recipients. But both the Equal Sessions and *Equals* share the common aim of promoting songwriting in the folk music ecosystem.

"Our main objective is that whenever a folk artist watches these series, they should be empowered to compose and write something new," says Abhinav Agrawal, the founder-director of Anahad. "We believe that's something through which they can be seen as equals, because currently they are only seen as performers."

Directed by Suruchi Sharma and shot by cinematographer Ankur Sanjeev, each 30-minute episode of *Equals* follows a fairly straightforward three-act format, comprising an introduction to the folk musician in their hometown or village, an initial meeting and subsequent jam session between all the artists in Greater Noida, and a stylised music video of their new tune. The focus is firmly on the folk stars, and the strongest aspect of the show is that it succeeds in bringing out their multi-layered personalities.

In December 2023, it won a special mention in the Best Short-Form Series category at the 2023 International Documentary Association Awards. ■

–Amit Gurbaxani

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hasn't been released under the band's name because they weren't involved in the writing process. In fact, the alternative rock band, which is fairly active on the live circuit, hasn't shared any fresh material since their 2012 comeback album *Evolve*, apart from the song 'Thief', which regularly features on their setlists.

Indus Creed's lack of releases contrasts with Parikrama's plan of launching 50 songs over the next three years. Last month, the classic rock band took out the atmospheric single 'Life Is Certain', which vocalist and lyricist Nitin Malik wrote to make a case for living life to the fullest. "Everyone says death is certain," he says. "[Consequently,] people tend to live in a very scared manner whereas the only reality in front of them is the life they have to deal with every day."

'Life Is Certain' will most likely be followed up by 'Don't Cut Me Down', which they premiered at the Independence Rock festival in Mumbai back in 1998. That, in turn, will precede their first-ever album, a limited edition vinyl LP of their performance at that same festival in 2023. The 10 tracks that make up the live recording will also be made available on audio-streaming services.

The packed schedule marks a significant change in approach for the 33-year-old group, which would release music at the rate of a tune a year during their first three decades. It's the result of the members having the bandwidth to sift through their incomplete compositions. "There's that folder of unfinished projects in everybody's computer," says Malik. "We realised that it just sitting there wasn't helping anyone, and decided to start working on stuff. Earlier, there was hardly any time because of work, and touring was mad." ■

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